

PW8 - Research and discuss the ethical and sustainability issues that arise from our generation and consumption of electricity

ELECTRICITY GENERATION

Focus on the processes that result in electricity being made available to those who need/want to use it

ELECTRICITY CONSUMPTION

Focus on the uses that electricity is put to by people and organisations

ETHICAL ISSUES

Matters of controversy (i.e. bad things versus good things) that arise due to

- what people/organisations do to generate electricity (A)
- what uses people and organisations put electricity to (B)

SUSTAINABILITY ISSUES

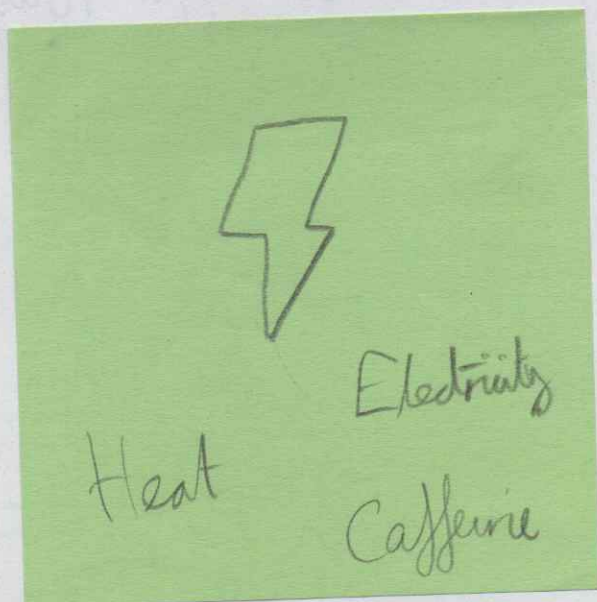
Matters that must be considered in order to be sure that our need/demand for and ability to produce electricity in the future will be manageable/realizable/sustainable. Consider this in terms of

- what people/organisations do to generate electricity (C)
- what uses people and organisations put electricity to (D)

ASSIGNMENT

Use the sheets that follow to help you research the issues and then write a short essay with the following title:

THE ETHICAL AND SUSTAINABILITY ISSUES THAT ARISE FROM OUR GENERATION AND CONSUMPTION OF ELECTRICITY



Electricity Generation and Consumption Assignment Sheet

A.

GENERATION OF ELECTRICITY – ETHICAL ISSUES

Matters of controversy (i.e. bad things versus good things) that arise due to what people/organisations do to generate electricity

Positive / Good

Renewable electricity is good for the planet because it doesn't pollute the atmosphere like fossil fuels

Wind-electricity generators are loud, which is bad for animals and people

Negative / Bad

Fossil fuels pollute the atmosphere
Most of the world's

electricity is from fossil fuels

~~big factor~~

Mining coal is bad as workers often work in rough conditions

B.

CONSUMPTION OF ELECTRICITY – ETHICAL ISSUES

Matters of controversy (i.e. bad things versus good things) that arise due to what uses people and organisations put electricity to

Most people waste a lot of electricity

Being in the shower for too long, leaving lights on or charging your phone overnight all waste electricity.

Some appliances have an eco mode that saves electricity

C.

GENERATION OF ELECTRICITY – SUSTAINABILITY ISSUES

Matters that must be considered in order to be sure that our need/demand for and ability to produce electricity in the future will be manageable/realizable/sustainable. Think of this in terms of what people/organisations do to generate electricity.

Fossil fuels aren't sustainable because they aren't renewable.

There is a limited amount. They harm the atmosphere with CO_2 .

Renewable energies such as solar, wind, wave or hydrothermal ~~are~~ don't harm the planet.

Nuclear isn't renewable but it's better than fossil fuels

D.

CONSUMPTION OF ELECTRICITY – SUSTAINABILITY ISSUES

Matters that must be considered in order to be sure that our need/demand for and ability to produce electricity in the future will be manageable/realizable/sustainable. Think of this in terms of what uses people and organisations put electricity to.